

[Return to Search](#)

The Hoggar Tuareg

Author(S): Lhote, Henri, Sipfle, Mary-Alice

Document Type: Book Chapter

Original Page: 148

Culture (OWC): [Tuareg \(MS25\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Northern Africa

Field Date: 1929-1940

Coverage Date: 1900-1940

Place Coverage: Algeria

Section Title(S): Chapter 1 Social Life

Among the Ih[˘]Aggaren violins are usually large, reaching as much as 40 centimeters in diameter. In Sudanese tribes, on the other hand, they are much smaller, rarely exceeding 25 to 30 centimeters.

171
[Comparative Evidence](#)

237
[Animal By-Products](#)

534
[Musical Instruments](#)

The amzad plays an important role among the Tuareg, who really make a true cult of it. Young men go to listen to the girls play it. After they are married, they love to hear their wives, who charm in this way the empty hours of summer evenings. Not playing the amzad is a punishment that the women inflict on the men, and during battles warriors always try to be brave lest their wives or their fiancées deprive them of music. "There will be no amzad," they used to say upon returning from an unsuccessful raid. This prospect was often sufficient to restore their courage and incite them to go efface their defeat.

533
[Music](#)

593
[Family Relationships](#)

626
[Social Control](#)

The ahal. — At about the age of sixteen, boys and girls have access to adult society and begin to participate in the ahal.

521
[Conversation](#)

571
[Social Relationships
And Groups](#)

882
Status Of Adolescents

The word ahal means "meeting, conversation, interview." A synonym for it is édéouenné. These musical and literary meetings have a more or less peculiar nature, depending on whether or not they are mixed with asri.

521
Conversation

571
Social Relationships
And Groups

882
Status Of Adolescents

Asri, literally "to run with the bridle loose," means the practice of some very free mores. To live in a state of asri is to exist under conditions which permit one to practice loose mores. Those who can be in a state of asri are pubescent boys and girls, widowers, and divorced people of either sex.

517
Leisure Time Activities

521
Conversation

533
Music

571
Social Relationships
And Groups

These meetings take place near the camps in the shelter of a wadi, but always out of the sight of old people and respectable people of the tribe. They usually take place before the evening ■ 148a Plate XIII

136
Fauna

291
Normal Garb

302
Personal Grooming

439
External Trade

517
Leisure Time Activities

521
Conversation

533
Music

571
Social Relationships
And Groups

Long-haired Ahaggar goat. This species is localized in the mountain massifs of the Central Sahara (Ahaggar, Aïr Adrar des Iforas. Tibesti).



Daman sheep, or Tuareg sheep, very widespread in the Sahelian steppe, is also rather common in the Ahaggar, but it is raised there only accessorially. It is a very sturdy beast, and many caravaneers import them from Adrar des Iforas

by making them cross the Tanezrouft. It is characterized by its long legs and long tail.



148b Plate XIV

Typical men's hair styles. The hair is braided and taken around to the back. The veil encircles the forehead, leaving the top of the head uncovered.



149 meal, which is taken very late, and more rarely after the meal if it is to entertain a stranger. Everyone sits in a circle. Each person takes a place in the order of his arrival, in such a way as to alternate men and women. When everyone has arrived, they elect a male president and a female president, whose job is to see that the usages and customs of the ahal are respected and, as a joke, 289 to inflict forfeits on those who bring on themselves the recriminations of the others. Sometimes only a female president is elected, but never a male president alone.

Human Relations Area Files

755 Prospect Street

New Haven, CT 06511

General Inquiries: ✉ hraf@yale.edu

Issues and Bugs: ✉ hraf-support@yale.edu



[Terms and Conditions](#) · [Accessibility](#) · [Cookie Policy](#)